

HS 555: Infrastructural Development in Highland South Asia

Course Code	HS 555
Course Name	Infrastructural Development in Highland South Asia
L-T-P-C	3-0-0-3
Intended for	M.A. (Development Studies) (Discipline Elective) and B.Tech. 3rd and 4th year
Approval	54th BoA (May 2024)

Course Contents

- Introduction to Anthropology of infrastructure (6 Hours)
 - The infrastructural turn
 - The mobility paradigm in anthropology
 - Promises and perils of infrastructural creation in highland South Asia
 - Road Ethnographies
- Connecting the remote: The poetics and politics (8 Hours)
 - From mule tracks to imperial highways
 - Remoteness and connectivity channels
 - Roads as the harbinger of progress, development and connectivity
 - Roads as state conceived spaces
 - Land acquisition and other issues.
- The Dromocratic revolution (6 Hours)
 - Speed and flows
 - Connection and communication channels
 - Corporeal and kinetic connection
- Mobility and Mobile connections (8 Hours)
 - Embodied travel experiences
 - Temporal and material conditions of infrastructure
 - Roadside contacts: stationary and the non-stationary
 - People as infrastructures: Gender experiences of mobility
- Tunneling and damming the hills (8 Hours)
 - The destructive production of infrastructure: railway tunnels and aerial connection
 - Dams and the moral ecology of infrastructure
 - Debri and debacle along infrastructure channels
 - Extraction of Raw-materials
- Infrastructure and Sustainability (6 Hours)
 - Issues of sustainability in infrastructure development
 - Loss of forested lands, natural habitats and other environmental concerns
 - Environmental Impact Assessment and other issues
 - Negotiating the loss.

Laboratory Modules

Field visits, invited lectures, film screening and other activities including evaluation of the Environmental and Social Impact assessment reports submitted before the commencement of the project.

Text Books

1. Anand, Nikhil, Akhil Gupta, and Hannah Appel, **The Promise of Infrastructure**, Duke University Press 2018.
2. Harvey, Penny, Casper Bruun Jensen, and Atsuro Morita, **Infrastructures and Social Complexity: A Companion**, Taylor & Francis, 2016.
3. Dalakoglou, D., Harvey, P. (Eds.), **Roads and Anthropology: Ethnography, Infrastructures, (Im)mobility**, Routledge, 2014.

References

1. Appel, Hannah, Anand, Nikhil and Gupta, Akhil Introduction: The Infrastructure Toolbox | Society for Cultural Anthropology (culanth.org), 2015.
2. Adey, P., Bissell, D., Hannam, K., Merriman, P., & Sheller, M. (Eds.), The Routledge Handbook of Mobilities, Routledge, 2013.
3. Bhatt, Jay P, Sudha Tiwari & Maharaj K. Pandit, Environmental impact assessment of river valley projects in upper Teesta basin of Eastern Himalaya with special reference to fish conservation: a review. Impact Assessment and Project Appraisal, 35:4, 340-350, DOI: [10.1080/14615517.2017.1354642](https://doi.org/10.1080/14615517.2017.1354642), 2017.
4. Cresswell, Tim and Peter Merriman., Geographies of Mobilities: Practices, Spaces, Subjects, Taylor & Francis, 2016.
5. Dalakoglou, D., The road: An ethnography of the Albanian-Greek cross-border motorway, American Ethnologist, no. 37 (1):132-149, 2010.
6. Delmon, Jeffrey, Public Private Partnership projects in Infrastructure: An essential guide for policy makers, Cambridge University Press, 2011.
7. Demenge, Jonathan P., The Road to Lingshed: Manufactured Isolation and Experienced Mobility in Ladakh. Himalaya, the Journal of the Association for Nepal and Himalayan Studies, 32 (1): 51–60, 2013.
8. Ferguson, J., The Anti-Politics Machine: 'Development,' Depoliticization, and Bureaucratic Power in Lesotho. 2003 ed. Minneapolis: University of Minnesota Press, 1994.
9. Gohain, Swargajyoti, Imagined Geographies in the Indo-Tibetan Borderlands: Culture, Politics, Place. Netherlands: Amsterdam University Press, 2020.
10. Gordillo, Gaston, Rubble: The afterlife of destruction. Durham: Duke University Press, 2014.
11. Gupta, Akhil, The future in ruins: Thoughts on the temporality of infrastructure. In N. Anand et al (eds.), The Promise of Infrastructure, Duke University Press, 2018.
12. Harvey, Penny., Knox, Hannah, The Enchantments of Infrastructure. Mobilities, 7:4, 521-536, DOI: [10.1080/17450101.2012.718935](https://doi.org/10.1080/17450101.2012.718935), 2012.
13. Harvey, Penny., Knox, Hannah, Roads: An Anthropology of Infrastructure and Expertise, Cornell University Press, 2015.
14. Masquelier, A., Road Mythographies: Space, Mobility, and the Historical Imagination in Postcolonial Niger, American Ethnologist, 29 (4):829-856, 2002.
15. Murton, Galen and Luke Heslop, Highways and Hierarchies: Ethnographies of Mobility from the Himalaya to the Indian Ocean, Amsterdam University Press, 2021.
16. Murton, Galen and Austin Lord, Trans-Himalayan power corridors: Infrastructural politics and China's Belt and Road Initiative in Nepal, Political Geography, 77 (102100): 1- 13, 2020.
17. Negi, D. P., & Abdul Azeez EP., 'No Means No': People's Protest Against Hydroelectric Development in Kinnaur, Himachal Pradesh, India, Contemporary Voice of Dalit, <https://doi.org/10.1177/2455328X2110694>, 2022.
18. Rest, Matthaus and Alessandro, Rippa, Road animism. HAU: Journal of Ethnographic Theory, 9: 373 - 389, 2019.
19. Saxer, Martin, Places in Knots: Remoteness and Connectivity in the Himalayas and Beyond, Cornell University Press, 2022.
20. Simpson, Edward, Highways to the End of the World: Roads, Roadmen and Power in South Asia, Hurst Publishers, 2022.
21. Simone, Abdou, Maliq, People as Infrastructure: Intersecting Fragments in Johannesburg, Public Culture, 16 (3): 407–429, 2004.
22. Star, Susan. Leigh, The Ethnography of Infrastructure. American Behavioral Scientists, 43 (3): 377-391, 1999.
23. Wiejaczka, Łukasz; Danuta Pirog; Lakpa Tamang; and Paweł Prokop, Local Residents' Perceptions of a Dam and Reservoir Project in the Teesta Basin, Darjeeling Himalayas, India. Mountain Research and Development, 38 (3): 203–210 <http://dx.doi.org/10.1659/MRD-JOURNAL-D-16-00124.1>, 2018
24. Ziipao, R. Raile, Infrastructure of Injustice: State and Politics in Manipur and Northeast India, Routledge, 2020.